Board Policy 6.40.013-P

Comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy

I. Background

A. Portland Public Schools (PPS) is committed to creating safe and healthy learning environments to support the growth and development of every student. The development of health literacy- the ability to access, understand, appraise, apply, and advocate for health information and services to maintain or enhance one's health and the health of others- is necessary for students to be healthy throughout their lives.

B. The Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child (WSCC) model responds to the call for greater alignment, integration, and collaboration between education and health to improve each child's cognitive, physical, social, and emotional development. It incorporates the components of a coordinated school health program, grounded in the tenets of a whole-child approach to education, and provides a framework for addressing the symbiotic relationship between learning and health.

C. PPS will take a comprehensive approach to reviewing and incorporating changes in policy, curriculum, and operating procedures to promote lifelong healthy behaviors and sustainable wellness practices for all students and staff. Implementing this policy relies on the collaboration of instructional, operational, clinical, and administrative staff at schools and central office departments. The PPS Wellness Policy will encompass the following:

i. School Food and Nutrition Program

ii. Physical Education & Physical Activity

iii. Comprehensive Health Education

iv. Healthy School Environment

v. Safe and Supportive Environment

vi. Health Services

vii. Employee Wellness

D. This Comprehensive Health and Wellness Policy, coupled with the associated Administrative Directives, will serve as overarching guidelines for each element of PPS's Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child model.

II. Policy

A. PPS is committed to eliminating disparities in health and educational outcomes by ensuring equitable access to wellness supports, health education, nutritious food, physical activity, safe environments, and health services for all students. To that end, the Superintendent will appoint a District Wellness Council, sometimes known as a

School Health Advisory Council (SHAC), to manage, coordinate, and evaluate the implementation of this wellness policy. The Council will:

i. Develop, recommend, review, and advise on implementing PPS policies addressing student and staff wellness.

ii. Delineate roles, responsibilities, actions, and timelines specific to the annual Wellness Action Plan;

a. The Action Plan will include specific goals and objectives for all components of the PPS WSCC Model and will operate in accordance with state and federal laws and the Oregon Department of Education's relevant educational standards.

iii. The District Wellness Council will periodically assess PPS's progress toward implementing the Wellness Policy and Wellness Action Plan and recommend continuous improvement efforts to the Superintendent.

iv. The Comprehensive Health and Wellness Policy and accompanying Wellness Action Plan will be reviewed periodically and updated as needed in accordance with federal and state requirements.

B. Family Engagement & Community Involvement

i. PPS will actively communicate ways in which the community can participate in the development, implementation, periodic review, and update of the District Wellness Policy and Action Plan through a variety of means appropriate for PPS. One of these methods will include community participation in the School Health Advisory Council. PPS will also ensure that communications are culturally and linguistically appropriate for the community and delivered through the same communication channels used by PPS central office and schools.

C. School Food & Nutrition Program

i. Nutrition promotion and education positively influence lifelong eating behaviors by using evidence-informed techniques and nutrition messages, creating food environments that encourage healthy nutrition choices, and encouraging participation in school meal programs. Students and staff will receive consistent nutrition messages throughout the school environment.

ii. Integral aspects of School Food & Nutrition Programs include, but are not limited to: school cafeteria and meal expectations, staff qualifications and professional development, competitive foods and beverages, celebrations and rewards, fundraising, and food and beverage marketing in schools.

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D. Physical Education & Physical Activity

i. Physical activity opportunities will be incorporated throughout the school experience for students in grades pre-K–12 and may include standards-based physical education, recess, classroom movement activities, and co-curricular opportunities. PPS will not withhold physical activity as punishment for any reason. OAR 581-022-2263 sets physical education requirements, and PPS will fulfill them accordingly.

E. Comprehensive Health Education

i. PPS requires all students in grades K–12 to receive comprehensive health education that is medically accurate, age- and developmentally appropriate, culturally and linguistically sustaining, inclusive of LGBTQ+ individuals and people of all abilities, and delivered in safe and supportive learning environments where all students feel valued. All PPS schools will take a skills-based approach to teach comprehensive health education that addresses a variety of topics, such as tobacco, alcohol, and other drug prevention and intervention, healthy eating/nutrition, mental and emotional health, personal health and wellness, physical activity, safety and injury prevention, violence prevention, and comprehensive sexual health education that is LGBTQ+ inclusive.

ii. Per state law, all schools must provide all students with standards-based comprehensive health education (HE).

a. Schools serving grades K-8 must provide at least 9 weeks of standards-based comprehensive health education annually. All lessons must be aligned with all relevant state laws, mandates, and standards.

b. All high school students must complete two semesters of standards-based comprehensive health education to graduate.

c. In grades 6-12, a licensed and endorsed health education teacher will teach comprehensive health education.

F. Healthy School Environment

i. PPS is committed to maintaining school facilities that are safe, clean, sanitary, accessible, and conducive to learning. PPS will maintain buildings and grounds in accordance with applicable health, safety, environmental, and accessibility standards.

ii. PPS recognizes that healthy physical environments are critical to preventing asthma and other chronic and infectious diseases that affect learning. PPS is committed to providing school buildings and grounds that are clean and in good repair, with healthy indoor air and water quality, sanitary and accessible bathrooms, and efficient resource use. PPS departments and all schools will

comply with existing federal and state regulations, city ordinances, and PPS policies related to promoting and managing healthy school environments.

G. Safe and Supportive Environment

i. PPS recognizes that suicide is a leading cause of death among youth and that many more youth consider and attempt suicide. The possibility of suicide and suicidal ideation requires vigilant attention from all PPS staff. As a result, PPS is committed to implementing best practices in suicide prevention, intervention, and postvention strategies to reduce risk, increase help-seeking behavior, identify students in need of support, and prevent suicide attempts and deaths. PPS also prioritizes creating safe, inclusive, and nurturing school environments grounded in belonging, emotional safety, and school connectedness, where all students feel valued and supported.

ii. In addition to suicide prevention efforts, PPS is committed to fostering school climates that are trauma-informed, restorative, and free from bias, discrimination, and harassment. These approaches support positive relationships, strengthen student resilience, and promote equitable access to learning. PPS recognizes that students' emotional well-being is directly connected to attendance, engagement, and academic success, and therefore emphasizes practices that build strong relationships, reinforce protective factors, and promote students' sense of belonging and self-worth.

H. Health Services

i. PPS aims to provide comprehensive, prevention-oriented health services to support all students' well-being and academic success. This policy guides schools' health service delivery and communicable disease management to remove barriers to learning, improve school attendance, increase health literacy, reduce risky behaviors, and promote healthy lifestyle choices. Health Services includes school nursing, medication administration and management, chronic disease management, preventive screenings, emergency preparedness and response, and care coordination to support students' physical, mental, and emotional health needs.

ii. The goal of Health Services is to ensure the health and safety of all students at each PPS-owned or leased facility where students are present for regular programming, to promote healthy school environments, and to provide education and access to effective health services. PPS also recognizes the importance of partnerships with families, community providers, and behavioral health organizations to support student wellness, early intervention, and access to care

I. Employee Wellness

i. PPS encourages staff to pursue a healthy lifestyle that contributes to improved health, higher morale, and a greater personal commitment to the

school's overall wellness program. Many actions and conditions that affect employee health may also influence students' health and learning. Employees' physical and mental health is integral to promoting and protecting students' health and fostering their academic success.

III. Related PPS Policies

A. 1.80.020-P: Non-discrimination/Anti-Harassment

B. 2.10.010-P: Racial Educational Equity Policy

C. 3.30.021-P: Tobacco Possession & Use

D. 4.30.050-P: Student Suicide Prevention

E. 4.30.060-P: Student Anti Harassment and Teen Dating Violence Policy

F. 4.30.063-AD: Title IX Sexual Harassment

G. 4.30.061-AD: Transgender, Nonbinary and Gender Diverse Students

H. 4.30.071-AD: Harassment, Sexual Violence, and Teen Dating Violence

I. 6.40.013-P: Comprehensive Health Education Policy [REVISED]

Legal Reference(s): ORS 329.496; ORS 334.125(7); ORS 336.423; OAR 581-022-2045; OAR 581-022-2050; OAR 581-051-0100; OAR 581-051-0305; OAR 581-051-0306; Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010, 42 U.S.C. § 1758b; National School Lunch Program, 7 C.F.R. Part 210; School Breakfast Program, 7 C.F.R. Part 220

History: Adopted 6/4/18; Amended 3/2021